What a PDF can contain

A hands-on specimen with selectable content and working interactive features. Click a section below or use your viewer's bookmarks panel.

01 / Typography & rich text

Headings, paragraphs, lists, columns, code and formulas.

02 / Tables & data graphics

Styled tables, vector charts, captions and notes.

03 / Images & vector artwork

Embedded raster image, paths, transparency and clipping.

04 / Links & annotations

Web links, page navigation, sticky notes and highlights.

05 / Interactive form

Text fields, multiline input, checkboxes, radio buttons and dropdown.

06 / Document features

Metadata, an embedded CSV, page geometry and capability notes.

Scope: a broad practical sample, not every object allowed by the PDF specification. Advanced features and viewer limitations are noted on the last page.

Typography & rich text

Text remains searchable and selectable. Formatting is represented by PDF text and drawing instructions.

Hierarchy and inline formatting

Bold emphasis, *italic text*, underlining, colored text, and ~~strikethrough~~ can coexist in a paragraph. Superscripts such as x^2 and subscripts such as H_2O are also possible.

Two-column layout

Unordered list

- Searchable body text
- Embedded font resources
- Precise positioning
- Repeated headers and footers

Ordered list

1. Open this document.
2. Select and copy some text.
3. Follow an internal link.
4. Complete the sample form.

Quotation

> *“A PDF is a page description that can also carry interactive objects and supporting files.”*

Code block

```
fn main() {
    println!("Hello, PDF!");
}
```

Formula: $E = mc^2$ | $f(x) = x^2 + 2x + 1$

[1] Footnote example: mathematical text here is formatted text, not an editable equation object.

Tables & data graphics

Fictional quarterly results demonstrate grid layout, numeric alignment, fills, borders and a scalable vector chart.

Quarter	Revenue	Cost	Margin
Q1	$12,000	$8,000	33.3%
Q2	$18,000	$11,000	38.9%
Q3	$24,000	$14,000	41.7%
Q4	$30,000	$17,000	43.3%
Total	**$84,000**	**$50,000**	**40.5%**

Revenue by quarter (USD thousands)

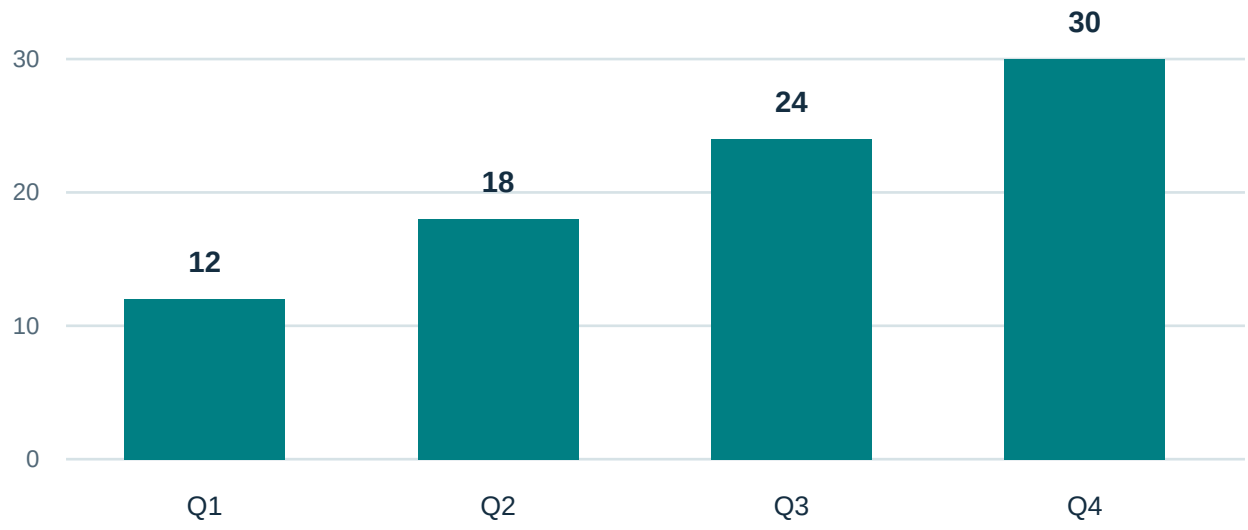


Figure 1. Vector bars stay crisp at high zoom. The same fictional dataset is embedded as sample-data.csv in this document.

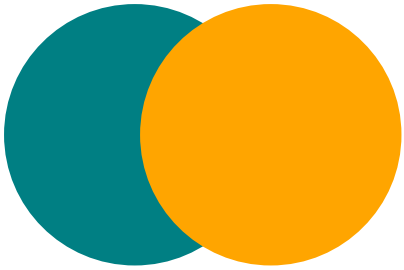
Images & vector artwork

PDF pages can mix pixel-based images with resolution-independent paths and graphics.



Figure 2. Embedded RGB raster illustration (800 × 360 pixels).

Vector shapes and transparency



Overlapping circles with alpha blending



A cubic Bézier curve

Clipping path



The raster image is clipped to a circular path.

Links & annotations

Try these real PDF objects. Annotation panels and hover behavior vary between viewers.

External hyperlink

Open example.com

This link opens a website only when selected.

Internal page navigation

Jump to the interactive form →

Return to the contents page →

Highlight annotation

This sentence has a genuine PDF highlight annotation.

Sticky-note annotation

Open the note icon near the right edge to read its comment.



Viewer tip
If comments or attachments are missing from the browser preview, download the file and open it in a full-featured PDF reader. Some previews only show static page content.

Interactive form

Enter sample values, change selections, then save a local copy. These are real AcroForm fields; nothing is submitted anywhere.

Name

Alex Example

Email

alex@example.com

Category

Personal

Preferred format

(●) Digital ( ) Print

☑ Enable sample notifications

Notes (multiline)

Try editing this text.
Your changes can be saved in a compatible reader.

No JavaScript, network submission or digital signature is included. A typed name is not a cryptographic signature.

Document-level features

Some PDF features live outside the visible page. Use your viewer's document properties, bookmarks and attachments panels.

Included in this file

- **Bookmarks:** seven section entries in the outline panel.
- **Metadata:** title, author, subject and keywords.
- **Embedded file:** sample-data.csv with the chart dataset.
- **Page geometry:** portrait A4 pages and explicit page boxes.
- **Interactive objects:** links, comments and form widgets.
- **Graphics:** text, raster images, vectors and transparency.

Other capabilities (not embedded here)

PDF can also carry digital signatures, optional-content layers, audio/video, 3D annotations, JavaScript actions, encryption, accessibility structure tags, and specialized print information such as spot colors. Support depends on the PDF version, reader and security settings.

Those features are deliberately described rather than simulated. This file is unsigned and unencrypted, contains no executable actions or rich media, and does not claim PDF/A, PDF/UA or PDF/X conformance.

Practical viewing checklist

1. Select text and zoom into the vector chart.
2. Navigate using the contents links and bookmarks.
3. Inspect the sticky note and highlight.
4. Edit the form and save it.
5. Extract sample-data.csv from the attachments panel.